

c. 1949

The following is a faithful transcription of typed notes by the
Servant of God, Father Solanus Casey, O.F.M.Cap.

A MILLION-DOLLAR ESSAY-PROPOSITION: (NO. II)

TO RESCUE FROM DESPAIR, ... THE HOPES AND SOULS OF BILLIONS.

HOPE, THE VERY SOUL OF HAPPINESS IN THIS WORLD:

DESPAIR, A FIRST FEATURE FORETASTE OF HELL

"KNOW THE TRUTH: AND THE TRUTH SHALL MAKE YOU FREE."

When shall we be delivered, or how extricate ourselves these days from the nightmare so long lingering as a prophesy; now as overnight by the threatening advances of international atheism and the consequent loss of faith in God, become an actuality - the nightmare of "wars and rumors of wars" so pathetically foretold when, according to the evangelists: "Jesus wept over Jerusalem"?

Only yesterday the writer's attention was called to a press report headed: "Non-Catholics Score Pope Disapprove of Bid for Union with Roman Church." Lamentable as such a scoring would seem, to God-fearing people - non-catholic as well as those in communion with Rome and the "Mother-Church", there should hardly be cause here for anyone's taking scandal. Such objections as are given may be in every case, "perfectly well intended". We hope they are. For, even among Catholics how comparatively few appreciate the outstanding, marvelous consistency and harmony in the stand of the Church and the continuous dogmatic, infallible dictions of Her supreme exponent on earth, Pope Pius XII. Dogmatic? Infallible shall we say? Not that they are as such proclaimed, or possibly intended; but Pope Pius XII would seem to be so imbued with a love of peace - his very name providentially proclaiming him so - and, one with his love of peace goes essentially his love of truth and of justice, that he can be said to like-live and breathe dogmatically; so much so in fact that his every sentence even in every-day speeches and conversations would seem to carry a sort of fundamental and a divine broadness and color, e.g., when a year or two back, writing to the Portuguese People, as would seem a congratulatory letter, he like defines education in such all embracing words, so simple, so concise, so unerringly consistent with other pronouncements and with dogmatic truth: "Education is the cooperation with God's grace in making perfect Christians."

Quite naturally such a pronouncement will hardly measurup with the ideals of non-christians: all the laws by atheism which somewhere has been defined as: "A climax at once, of intellectual insanity and of moral degeneracy".